Twitter, where any user who signs up on the platform can post any piece of content (images, videos, website links). Like Facebook and Twitter, allowing unmoderated content means the app can also be used to spread fake news. As the journalist Samarth Bansal reported in 2019, 'The user-generated content is clearly a problem, which makes the problem similar to other platforms. But the NaMo app has another unique aspect: the promoted accounts on the app's news feed, called "My Network". The feed, like on every social media platform, allows users to see all posts from people they follow in one place. But this section also promotes posts from a set of accounts … The promotion of such accounts on the NaMo app makes its millions of users vulnerable to misleading information.' A typical sample of such a post is one by Sanjay Gupta: 'Of the total 40,000 rape cases in India in the last ten years, 39,000 had a Muslim rapist. Still, Congress and Rahul Gandhi say that Hindus are rapists and terrorists. Shame on Congress and Gandhi family!' Another one says '92% of the Muslims voted in Karnataka elections, 86% Christians voted, but just 58% Hindus. 42% Hindus didn't even vote.' Neither is substantiated by data.

The BJP's Malviya is emphatic that the app cannot be responsible for what its users post. 'It is user-generated, anybody can write anything. You can also write in something and it may be wrong. If it is not kosher, how am I going to respond?'[67] As he told Bansal at the time, there is 'some scope for misinformation' on the platform and 'multiple posts have been taken down'.[68]

## *Cyber Yoddhas, Hate Speech, Fake News and Digital Tools: The BJP View*

There is a view that the BJP has been more adept at weaponising social media.[69] How does the party respond to charges of abusive language and hate speech by the IT cell? Malviya argued that the digital domain, where everyone could proclaim their own history and story, allowed the party to bypass traditional gatekeepers of information, build and propagate its own narrative and broadcast it. His response is worth recording in full:[70]